Insurance Aging Checklist

A follow-up routine for claims stuck past 30, 60, 90 and 120 days

Aged A/R is rarely one big problem. It is hundreds of small claims that each needed one more touch. This checklist gives every bucket a defined action.

1. Set the rules before you work the report

- [ ] Every claim has an assigned follow-up date at submission, not after it ages.
- [ ] The A/R report is worked oldest-first within each bucket, not newest-first.
- [ ] No claim sits untouched for more than 14 days at any point in its life.
- [ ] Every call, fax and portal check is logged in the patient ledger with a date.

2. 0 to 30 days

- [ ] Confirm the claim was accepted by the clearinghouse, not just sent by the PMS.
- [ ] Check for a payer acknowledgment and match the count and total to what you submitted.
- [ ] Verify attachments were received; missing attachments are the most common early stall.
- [ ] Nothing further needed if the payer's normal turnaround is inside this window.

3. 31 to 60 days

- [ ] Check eligibility again; a terminated plan explains most silent stalls.
- [ ] Confirm the claim is on the payer's system by reference number, not just by your records.
- [ ] If the payer shows no claim, resubmit with the original date of service and a note explaining the resubmission.
- [ ] Escalate to a supervisor line rather than repeating the front-line IVR.

4. 61 to 90 days

- [ ] Pull the EOB or EFT and read the actual adjudication, not just the balance.
- [ ] Identify whether this is unpaid claim, partial payment, or a payment posted to the wrong patient.
- [ ] Open the appeal the same day you identify the reason; do not schedule it for later.
- [ ] Notify the patient if the balance is now theirs, with the explanation in writing.

5. Over 90 days

- [ ] Confirm timely filing has not been lost; if it has, document who owned the delay.
- [ ] Escalate to the payer's provider relations or dental claims manager with a claim list, not one claim at a time.
- [ ] Decide a cut-off point where write-off is cheaper than continued labour, and apply it consistently.
- [ ] Add the denial reason to your tracking sheet so the same payer mistake does not reach 90 days again.

Bottom line: The goal is not to work aged claims faster. It is to stop claims becoming aged. Review the reasons behind your 90-day bucket monthly and fix the step upstream that produced them.